

HIRING & RECRUITMENT POLICY

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1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this Hiring & Recruitment Policy is to establish a structured, transparent and consistent process for identifying, assessing and selecting individuals for employment and professional engagement at BSmile The Mind Studio.

As a mental health organisation, BSmile recognises the importance of appointing individuals who possess the required educational qualifications, professional experience, the appropriate technical competence, professional conduct, attitude, communication skills and suitability for working within a mental health care environment.

This policy aims to ensure that recruitment decisions are based on the requirements of the position and the overall suitability of the candidate for the role and the organisation.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to the recruitment and selection of:

- Full-time employees
- Part-time employees
- Clinical and mental health professionals
- Administrative and operational employees
- Sales and business development employees
- Marketing employees
- Management positions
- Consultants and other professional engagements
- Interns and trainees, where applicable

The recruitment process may be modified according to the nature, seniority and professional requirements of a particular position.

3. HIRING PRINCIPLES

3.1 3A Principle

BSmile's hiring decisions are guided by the **3A Principle - Ability, Aptitude and Attitude**. Candidates are assessed not only on their qualifications and experience, but also on their capacity to perform, learn, adapt and contribute positively to the organisation.

- **Ability:** The candidate's existing knowledge, qualifications, professional competence, technical skills and capacity to perform the responsibilities of the role.
- **Aptitude:** The candidate's capacity to learn, adapt, solve problems, make decisions and develop within the role.
- **Attitude:** The candidate's professionalism, work ethic, communication, teamwork, openness to feedback, responsibility and approach towards clients, colleagues and the organisation.

3.2 Merit and Competence

Candidates shall be evaluated based on qualifications, relevant experience, professional competence, skills and suitability for the requirements of the position.

3.3 Professional Standards

Candidates appointed to clinical, mental health or other regulated professional positions shall meet the educational, professional registration, licensing and other applicable requirements relevant to the role.

3.4 Fair and Consistent Selection

The recruitment process shall be conducted using role-relevant and reasonable criteria, with candidates assessed consistently throughout the selection process.

3.5 Organisational Suitability

In addition to technical competence, BSmile shall consider the candidate's suitability for the organisation's professional environment, work culture, expectations and collaborative approach.

3.6 Integrity and Transparency

Recruitment decisions shall be made with professionalism, integrity and transparency, and candidates shall be expected to provide accurate information and documentation throughout the recruitment process.

3.7 Confidentiality

Candidate information, documents, interview discussions and assessment outcomes shall be treated as confidential and accessed only by authorised personnel involved in the recruitment process.

3.8 Verification

Relevant educational qualifications, professional credentials, experience and other information provided by a selected candidate may be verified before appointment.

4. IDENTIFICATION OF STAFFING REQUIREMENT

The recruitment process shall begin when a staffing requirement or vacancy is identified.

A hiring requirement may arise due to:

- Creation of a new position
- Expansion of an existing service
- Increase in workload or client requirements
- Resignation or separation of an employee
- Replacement of an existing position
- Requirement for specialised professional expertise
- Operational or organisational requirements

Before recruitment begins, the requirement for the position shall be assessed and approved by the appropriate management authority.

The requirement shall clearly identify:

- Position title
- Department/function
- Reason for hiring
- Employment type
- Required qualifications
- Required experience
- Technical competencies
- Soft skills
- Other role-specific requirements

5. JOB REQUIREMENT FINALISATION

Before a vacancy is advertised, the requirements of the position shall be clearly defined.

The hiring team shall determine the following:

5.1 Educational Qualifications

The minimum and preferred educational qualifications required for the position.

5.2 Professional Qualifications and Registration

Where applicable, the candidate must possess the required professional registration, license, certification or other legally/professionally recognised credential for the position.

For clinical and allied health positions, relevant professional credentials shall be verified before appointment.

5.3 Experience

The required level and nature of professional or work experience shall be determined based on the position.

5.4 Technical Skills

The specific knowledge and technical competencies required to perform the role.

5.5 Soft Skills

Relevant interpersonal and professional competencies, including communication, teamwork, adaptability, professionalism, problem-solving and other role-specific requirements.

5.6 Other Requirements

Additional requirements such as location, availability, working hours, language proficiency or other role-specific criteria may be specified where relevant to the position.

6. JOB DESCRIPTION AND RECRUITMENT CONTENT

Once the requirements of the position have been finalised, an appropriate Job Description (JD) and recruitment communication shall be prepared.

The recruitment content shall, as appropriate, include:

- Position title
- Location
- Employment type
- Educational qualification
- Required experience
- Professional registration/licensing requirements
- Key responsibilities
- Required technical skills

- Required soft skills
- Application procedure
- Other relevant role-specific information

The final recruitment content shall be shared with the Marketing Team for preparation and publication of the recruitment poster or other approved recruitment material.

7. RECRUITMENT SOURCES

BSmile may use one or more appropriate recruitment channels depending on the position and recruitment requirement.

These may include:

- BSmile's LinkedIn profile
- Social media platforms
- WhatsApp status/stories
- Relevant professional or graduate groups
- Professional contacts and networks
- Employee/professional referrals
- Direct contacts
- Meta advertisements
- Other suitable job portals or recruitment platforms

The recruitment channels selected may vary according to the nature of the vacancy and the type of candidate being sought.

8. APPLICATION RECEIPT AND CANDIDATE SHORTLISTING

Applications and candidate leads received through the recruitment channels shall be reviewed against the requirements of the position.

An initial screening may be conducted through telephone or other appropriate communication with the candidate.

Candidates may be shortlisted based on:

- Educational qualifications
- Professional credentials

- Relevant work experience
- Nature and quality of previous experience
- Technical suitability
- Location, where relevant to the role
- Availability
- Communication skills
- Other position-specific requirements

Only candidates who reasonably meet the requirements of the position shall ordinarily proceed to the interview stage.

9. INTERVIEW AND SELECTION PROCESS

BSmile shall generally follow a **two-stage interview process**, subject to modification based on the position.

Stage 1 – Technical/Functional Interview

The first round shall primarily assess the candidate's technical and professional competence. For clinical, psychological, allied health or other specialised professional positions, the interview panel may include:

- A relevant BSmile professional
- A qualified/experienced professional from the respective field
- Other personnel considered appropriate by management

For example, in the recruitment of an Occupational Therapist, the first-round panel may include a BSmile psychologist and an experienced Occupational Therapist.

The technical interview may assess:

- Educational foundation
- Professional knowledge
- Practical understanding
- Previous experience
- Role-specific technical skills
- Case-based or practical understanding, where appropriate

- Professional judgement
- Problem-solving ability
- Understanding of ethical and professional responsibilities

The first round shall also assess the candidate's **aptitude, attitude and ability** in relation to the position.

Only candidates considered suitable following the first round shall ordinarily proceed to the second round.

10. SECOND-ROUND MANAGEMENT INTERVIEW

Candidates who successfully clear the first-round assessment shall be forwarded for the management interview.

The second round may be conducted by the Director, Manager and/or other authorised management representatives.

The management interview shall assess areas including:

- Overall suitability for the organisation
- Professional attitude
- Communication and interpersonal skills
- Organisational expectations
- Role expectations
- Availability and joining requirements
- Compensation expectations
- Alignment between candidate expectations and BSmile's requirements
- Other management-level considerations

The management team shall make the final selection decision based on the overall assessment of the candidate.

11. INTERVIEW EVALUATION

Interviewers shall assess candidates based on criteria relevant to the position.

Depending on the role, assessment may include:

- Educational qualifications
- Relevant experience
- Technical competence
- Aptitude
- Professional attitude
- Communication
- Problem-solving ability
- Role suitability
- Professionalism
- Organisational suitability
- Compensation alignment
- Other role-specific requirements

The assessment should consider the candidate's overall suitability rather than relying solely on one factor or one stage of the interview.

12. SELECTION AND APPROVAL

Following completion of the interview process, the selected candidate shall be approved by the authorised management personnel.

The final selection shall be based on:

1. Meeting the minimum requirements of the position
2. Performance during the interview/assessment process
3. Professional and technical suitability
4. Organisational suitability
5. Verification of relevant credentials and information
6. Management approval.

No candidate shall be considered formally appointed until the required approval and appointment process has been completed.

13. BACKGROUND AND DOCUMENT VERIFICATION

Following selection and prior to or as part of appointment formalities, BSmile may conduct appropriate verification of the selected candidate's information.

Depending on the position, this may include verification of:

- Identity documents
- Educational qualifications
- Professional qualifications
- Professional registration/license
- Relevant certifications
- Previous employment/experience
- References, where required
- Other role-specific credentials

For clinical and professional positions, verification of applicable professional registration or licensing shall be given particular importance.

If material discrepancies, false information, forged documents or misrepresentation are identified, BSmile reserves the right to withdraw the selection or offer, subject to applicable requirements and organisational procedures.

14. DOCUMENT SUBMISSION

The selected candidate shall be required to submit the documents specified by BSmile for appointment.

The required documentation may include:

- Identity proof
 - Educational certificates
 - Professional registration/licence
 - Relevant experience certificates
 - Photograph
 - Bank/payment details
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- Emergency contact details

The specific documentation required may vary depending on the position and employment type.

15. OFFER LETTER

Following completion of the selection process and required approvals, BSmile shall issue an Offer Letter to the selected candidate.

The Offer Letter shall contain applicable employment or engagement terms, including:

- Designation
- Employment/engagement type
- Compensation/Salary/Stipend
- Joining date, Probation Period terms
- Working hours or applicable schedule
- Reporting structure
- Applicable terms and conditions
- Any Other relevant appointment terms

The candidate shall be required to review and accept the Offer Letter in the manner specified by BSmile.

16. EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK AND ORGANISATIONAL POLICIES

The selected candidate shall be provided with the applicable **Employee Handbook** along with or during the offer and appointment process.

The candidate shall be expected to read, understand and comply with the policies, procedures, professional standards and workplace expectations contained therein.

The Employee Handbook shall operate alongside the Offer Letter and other applicable organisational policies.

17. JOINING AND ONBOARDING

Following acceptance of the Offer Letter, the candidate shall be provided with a confirmed joining date.

On or around the date of joining, BSmile shall conduct an appropriate onboarding/orientation process.

The onboarding process may include:

- Welcome and introduction to the organisation
- Introduction to the team
- Explanation of organisational structure
- Explanation of reporting hierarchy
- Introduction to relevant departments/personnel
- Explanation of organisational workflow
- Explanation of role and responsibilities
- Introduction to applicable policies, procedures and documentation.
- Other role-specific orientation or training

The extent of onboarding may vary according to the position and level of responsibility.

18. CONFIDENTIALITY OF RECRUITMENT INFORMATION

All candidate information obtained during recruitment shall be treated as confidential.

Recruitment information shall be shared only with personnel who are authorised or reasonably required to participate in the recruitment and selection process.

Interview discussions, candidate evaluations, personal documents and other recruitment-related information shall not be disclosed unnecessarily to unauthorised individuals.

19. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Any person participating in the recruitment or selection process shall disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest involving a candidate.

Where a conflict may affect the fairness or objectivity of the selection process, management may reassign the relevant interviewer or decision-maker.

Personal relationships or external interests shall not improperly influence recruitment decisions.

20. EQUAL AND FAIR OPPORTUNITY

BSmile shall seek to maintain a fair and professional recruitment process.

Employment decisions shall be based on legitimate requirements of the position, qualifications, competence, experience, professional suitability and organisational requirements.

BSmile does not discriminate on the basis of race, caste, colour, religion, gender, sex, sexual orientation, age, disability, marital status, nationality, social or economic background, or any other status protected under applicable law, except where a specific requirement is a legitimate and lawful occupational requirement.

Selection criteria shall be relevant to the position and applied consistently.

21. RECRUITMENT OF INTERNS, CONSULTANTS AND PART-TIME PROFESSIONALS

Interns, consultants and part-time professionals may be recruited through a process appropriate to the nature of their engagement.

The organisation may modify the standard recruitment process based on:

- Duration of engagement
- Nature of responsibilities
- Professional requirements
- Level of supervision
- Qualification requirements
- Scope of work

All such engagements shall be subject to applicable documentation, confidentiality requirements and organisational policies.

22. RECRUITMENT RECORDS

BSmile shall maintain appropriate recruitment records, which may include:

- Job description
- Recruitment advertisement/poster
- Candidate applications
- Shortlisting records
- Interview records/evaluations

- Selection decision
- Submitted documents
- Offer Letter
- Other relevant recruitment documentation

Recruitment records shall be maintained and accessed in accordance with organisational requirements and applicable data/privacy obligations.

23. EXCEPTIONS

Where exceptional circumstances require deviation from the standard recruitment process, such deviation shall require approval from the authorised management personnel. Any exception should be based on a legitimate organisational requirement and should not compromise professional standards, credential requirements or the integrity of the recruitment process.

24. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Management

Management shall:

- Approve staffing requirements where applicable
- Participate in the final selection process
- Assess organisational and financial suitability
- Approve final appointments
- Approve exceptions to the recruitment process

Hiring Representative

The relevant hiring representative shall:

- Identify and communicate the staffing requirement
- Define role requirements
- Participate in shortlisting and interviews
- Assess functional suitability
- Coordinate with relevant professionals where required

Marketing Team

The Marketing Team shall:

- Prepare recruitment creatives based on approved recruitment requirements
- Publish recruitment content through approved channels
- Support recruitment campaigns and advertisements

Interview Panel

The interview panel shall:

- Conduct objective and role-relevant assessments
- Assess technical and professional competence
- Provide appropriate feedback/recommendations
- Maintain confidentiality of candidate information

Candidate

Candidates shall:

- Provide accurate and complete information
- Submit required documents
- Participate in the recruitment process in good faith
- Disclose relevant information required for appointment
- Comply with the terms of the Offer Letter and applicable organisational policies upon joining

25. POLICY COMPLIANCE

All recruitment activities at BSmile The Mind Studio shall be conducted in accordance with this policy, the applicable organisational policies and applicable laws, regulations and professional requirements in force from time to time.

Where a specific professional or statutory requirement applies to a position, the relevant requirement shall take precedence over a general recruitment practice.

26. POLICY REVIEW AND AMENDMENT

This policy shall be reviewed periodically by the management of BSmile The Mind Studio to ensure that it remains appropriate to the organisation's operational requirements and applicable professional and regulatory requirements.

BSmile reserves the right to modify, amend or update this policy as required.

All amendments shall be communicated to the relevant personnel as appropriate.

27. RECRUITMENT PROCESS SUMMARY

Staffing Gap Identified



Position & Requirement Finalised



Qualification, Experience & Skill Criteria Defined



Recruitment Content/JD Prepared



Marketing & Recruitment Channels Activated



Applications/Leads Received



Initial Screening & Shortlisting



Round 1 – Technical/Functional Interview



Assessment of Aptitude, Attitude & Ability



Round 2 – Management Interview



Final Selection & Management Approval



Document Submission



Background & Credential Verification



Offer Letter Issued





Candidate Acceptance & Signing



Joining Date Confirmed



Welcome & Organisational Orientation



Role/Workflow/Hierarchy Explained



Employee Handbook & Applicable Policies Provided



Joining & Onboarding Completed.

